COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, DRESSING (Potts-Smith)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-F-36902(1) which is cancelled.

This commercial item description covers two sizes of dressing forceps suitable for use in cardiovascular surgery.

Salient characteristics:

General. Forceps shall be clean and free from any polishing compound, debris, or oil.

Material. Forceps shall be manufactured from martensitic or type 430 ferritic corrosion resistant steel of composition in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard F899.

Hardness. Forceps manufactured from martensitic corrosion resistant steel shall have a Rockwell hardness of HRC 40-48. Forceps manufactured from ferritic corrosion resistant steel shall have a Rockwell hardness of HRC 18-24.

Style and design. Forceps shall be in accordance with figure 1 for the National Stock Number specified. Tips shall mate precisely, with no overlap in either the axial or lateral view. Teeth shall mate uniformly and completely.

Finish. The finish shall be mirror or satin. The finish shall be uniform and free from cracks, pits, rough areas, crevices, and grind or tool marks.

Passivation. Forceps shall be passivated.

Markings. Forceps shall be permanently and legibly marked with the contractor's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless". Instruments of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Workmanship. All forceps shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform and free from defects which affect life, utility, or appearance.

Product Quality Level.

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Each (EA). One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Examination. Forceps shall be examined to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps. Sampling shall be level S-1. The same samples may be used for the Hardness and corrosion test. AQL shall be 1.0.

Tests.

Corrosion Resistance. Forceps shall be tested for corrosion resistance in accordance with ASTM Standard F1089.

Hardness. Forceps shall be tested for Rockwell hardness in accordance with ASTM Standard E18 or Standards E92 and E140.

Metric Products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting of rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and reguations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-00-333-3700	FORCEPS, DRESSING, STRAIGHT 10 Inch
6515-01-089-5669	FORCEPS, DRESSING, STRAIGHT, Potts-Smith, 12 Inch

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and or order).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

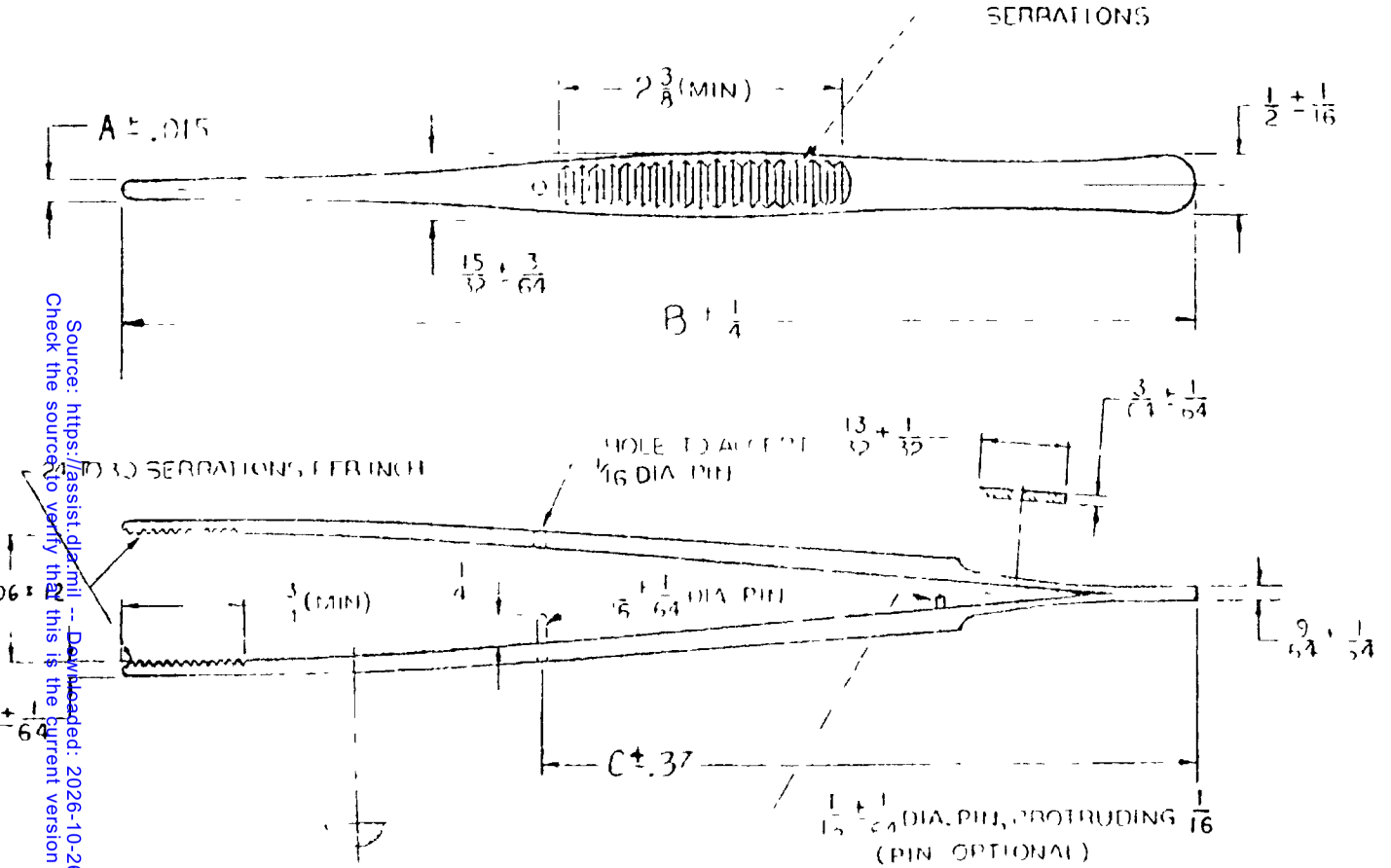
DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4338

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



NSN	A	B	C
6515 00-333-3700	1.56	10	6.25
6515 01-088-5667	.620	12	7.10

NOTES:
1. ALL DIMENSIONS ARE INCHES
2. TEETH SHALL MESH UNIFORMLY AND COMPLETELY.
3. TIPS SHALL MATE PRECISELY WITHOUT OVERLAP

FIGURE 1. FORCEPS, DRESSING, POTTS-SMITH

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53630	FORCEPS, DRESSING (Potts-Smith)

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION (M
	☐ VENDOR
b ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code)	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER (Specify

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER (Last, First, MI) – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER (Include Area Code) – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code) – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION (YYMM

(TO DETACH THIS FORM, CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil - Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form f ubmitting comments and suggestions for improvements All users of military standardization documents are invited to suggestions This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAP* mailed In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpreta too rigid, restrictive loose ambiguous, or was incompatible and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate problems Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document If block 7 is filled out acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are be considered

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification specification requirements on current contracts Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply author to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements

(Fold along this line)

Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4956 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:22Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center